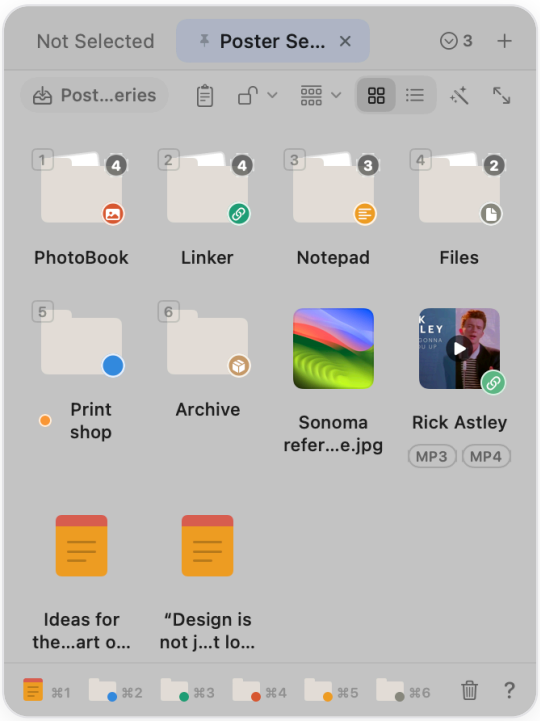
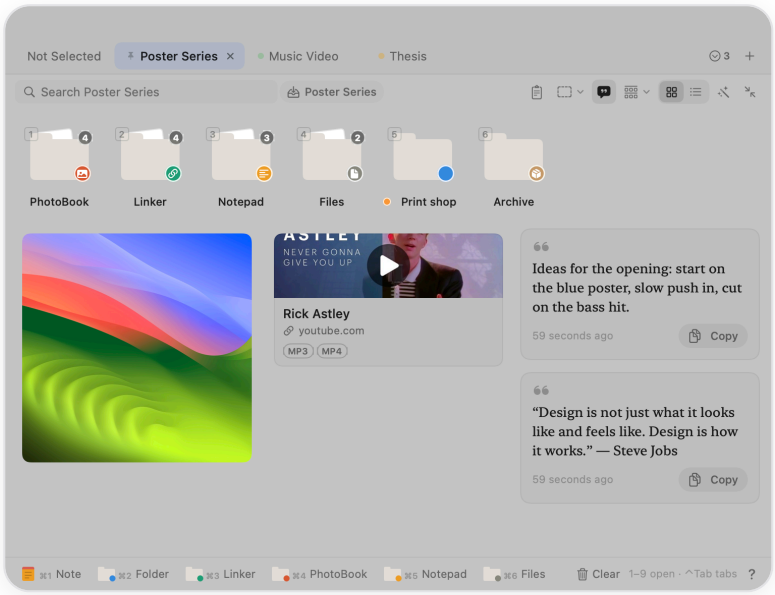
MACOS MENU BAR APP · OCTOBER 2026

Stash

A quiet scrapbook for creative projects. Throw links, pictures, notes, files, music and video into it without leaving what you're doing — Stash keeps them in projects and folders, and as real files on your Mac.



The pop-up, hanging from the menu bar



The big window, everything in full

What it's for

- **Capture without switching.** ⌥Space opens it over any app; paste, drop or press ⌥⌘V to save without opening it at all.
- **Organise like Finder.** Projects as tabs, folders that sort themselves, free placement, colour tags, Get Info, Quick Look.
- **Nothing locked in.** Every project and folder is a real folder on disk; drag anything out and it arrives as a real Mac file.

01 · DESIGN CHOICES

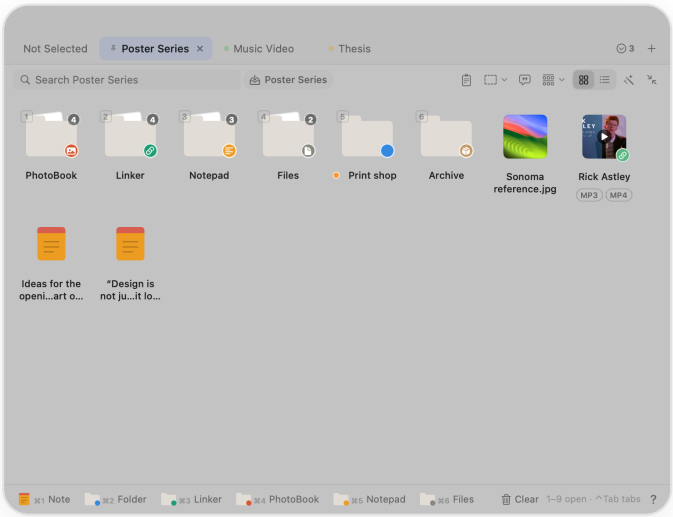
Quiet, grey, and out of the way

The content is the colour. The interface stays a soft grey, so links, pictures and notes are what you see.

CHOICE	WHAT IT MEANS IN THE APP
Minimal chrome	Flat grey surfaces (macOS material), hairline dividers, no heavy borders or shadows. Icon-only tools that only show a soft grey when hovered.
Finder as the model	Selection is a grey box behind the icon with the name in a blue pill; Return renames, ⌘⌫ deletes, Space previews, arrows move, 1–9 open folders.
Two windows, one board	A small pop-up (330 × 440) for quick capture and a big movable window for organising. Both float above other apps without taking focus away from them.
Two-row header	Like a browser: project tabs on their own strip, the tools in a slim row underneath.
Folders: "Dot" design	Every folder is the same quiet grey shape; only a small coloured dot says what kind it is. The board stays calm.
Fullness, not decoration	Folders show how full they are — sheets peek out (1–5 things, then a stack) and a small count (20+ after twenty).
Minimal or full	The ❝ switch: minimal icon tiles, or everything in full (link previews, file details, notes as quote cards).
Day and night by the clock	Light during the day, dark from 7 pm to 7 am — nothing to switch.
Serif for words	Notes shown as quotes use a serif face, so written words read differently from the interface around them.
Soft project tints	Each project has a muted tint (blue-grey, sage, sand, rose, lavender, teal); Not Selected stays plain grey.

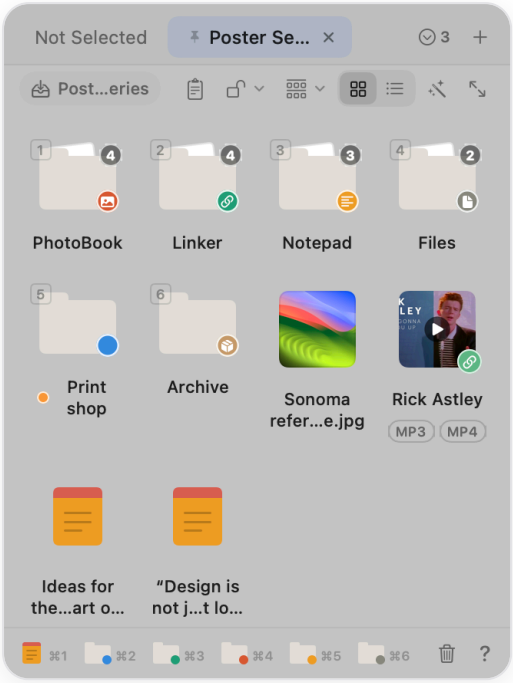
Folder and type colours

Folder · Linker (links) · PhotoBook (pictures) · Notepad (notes) · Files · Kraft · Pastel · Midnight

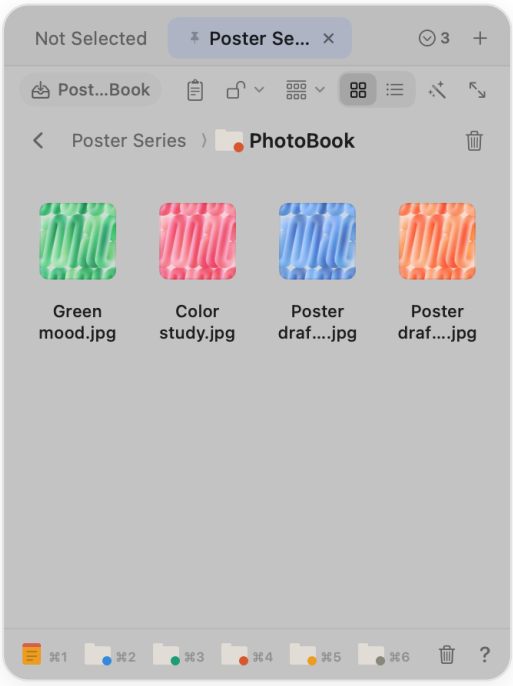


Minimal view: folders with their dots and counts, items as tiles

The pop-up and the big window



Pop-up: tabs, the tool row, the board, the bottom bar



Inside a folder: path with Back, everything inside

The pop-up

- Hangs under the menu bar icon; ⌥Space toggles it from any app.
- Everything is a small icon tile with its name: pictures as thumbnails, files with their real Mac icons, links with their preview and a link badge.
- **Lock / Unlock** (🔒 ▾): drag it anywhere by its top bar, lock it, and it reopens exactly there.

The big window

- ⤢ expands; it can be moved and resized — or locked: draw a frame on screen (**Draw Frame…**) or **Lock** it where it is; it shows an orange 🔒 Locked.
- Search (current tab only, folders and items), the ❝ minimal/full switch, Arrange By, Icons | List, the Organize wand.

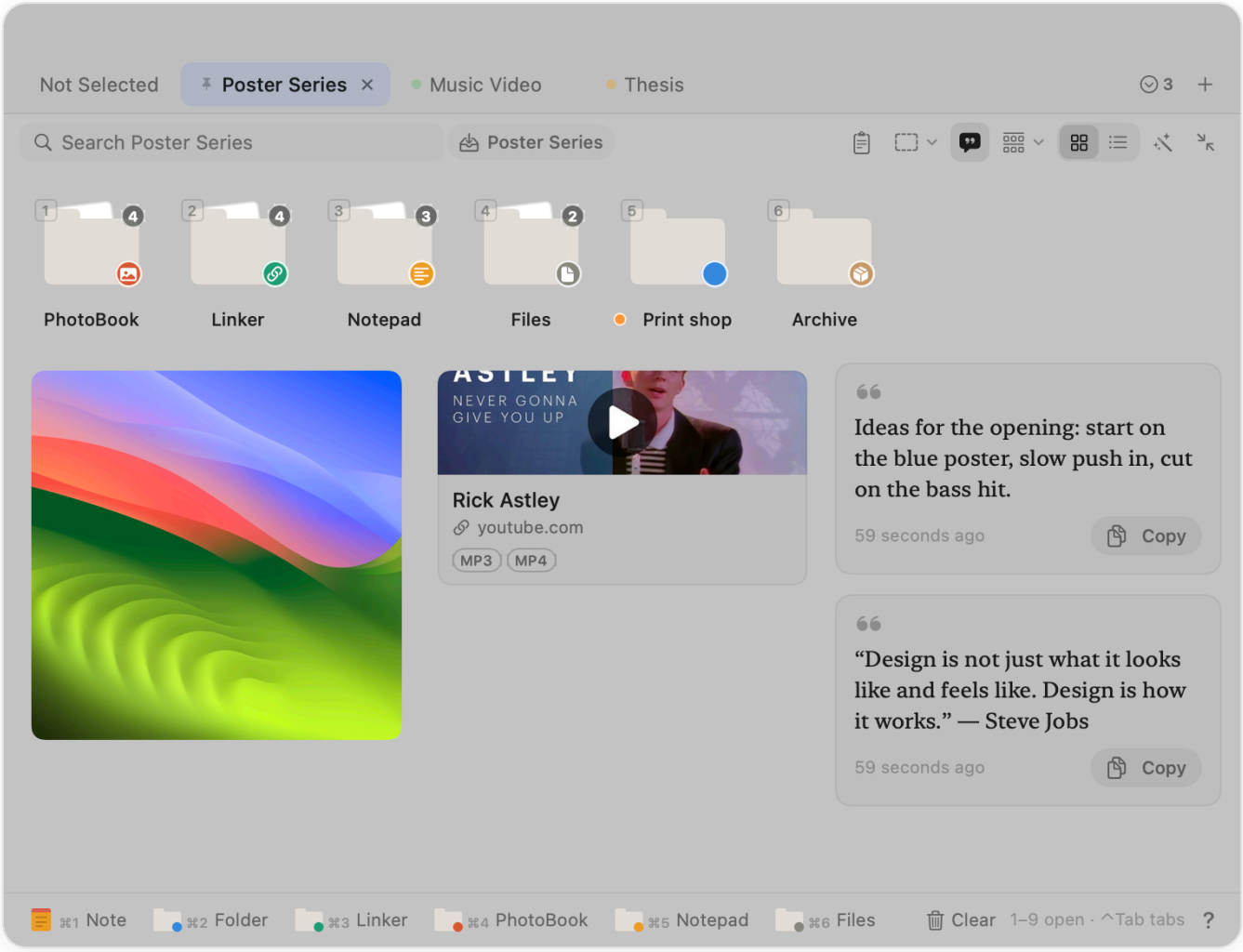
The tool row

- ↓ **Project** ▸ **Folder** always shows where new things will be saved.
- 📋 Recent copies · 🔒 Lock · ❝ view · Arrange By ▾ · Icons | List · wand · expand. Each can be hidden in Settings → Toolbar.

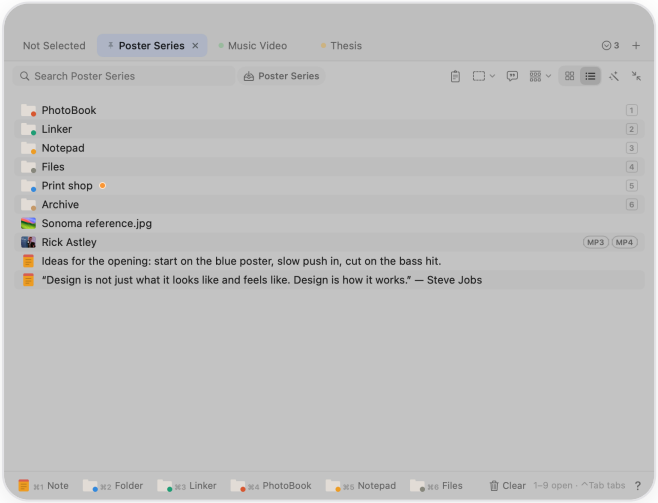
The bottom bar

- `⌘1` Note, `⌘2` Folder, `⌘3` Linker, `⌘4` PhotoBook, `⌘5` Notepad, `⌘6` Files — each with its own coloured icon.
- 🗑 **Clear** empties the tab (two clicks, Undo, Recently Deleted), and **?** lists every button.

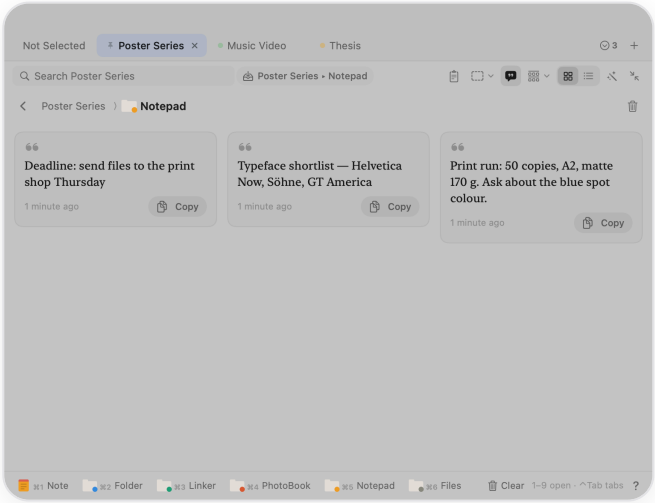
Icons, full view, list



Full view (❝ on): the picture, the YouTube card with MP3/MP4, notes as quotes with Copy



List view, Finder-style rows

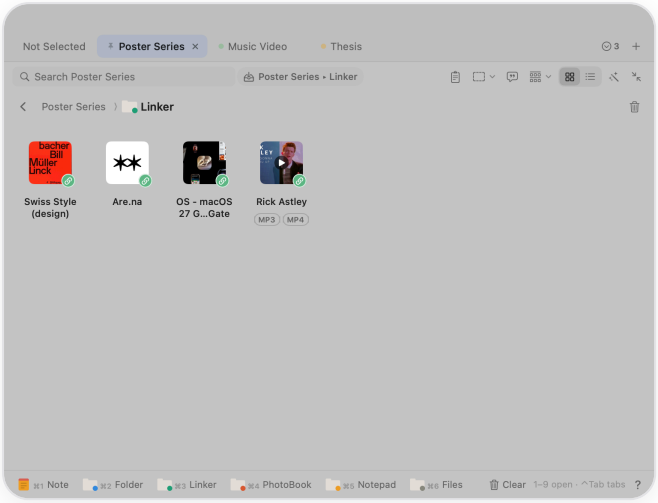


A Notepad folder in full view: notes to read and copy

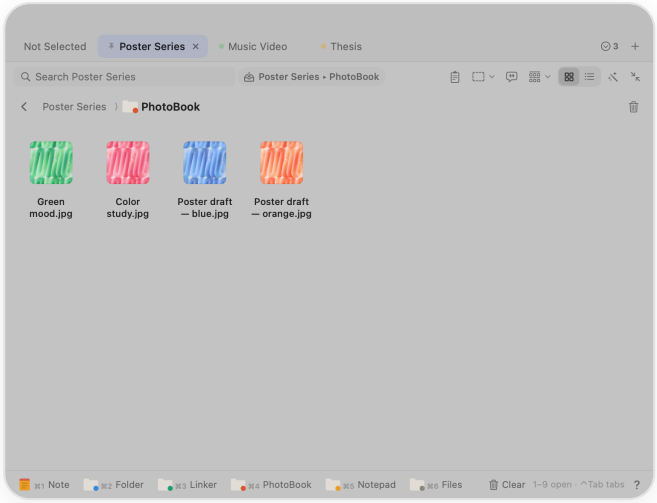
- **Free placement** (Arrange By: None): drag anything anywhere and it stays; new things take the first free spot. Name, Kind, Date Added or Tags line everything up again.
- Each window and each view keeps its own arrangement. Folder numbers 1–9 follow where the folders sit.

04 · FOLDERS AND THINGS

Typed folders that sort themselves



Linker: links with their page pictures; YouTube gets MP3/MP4

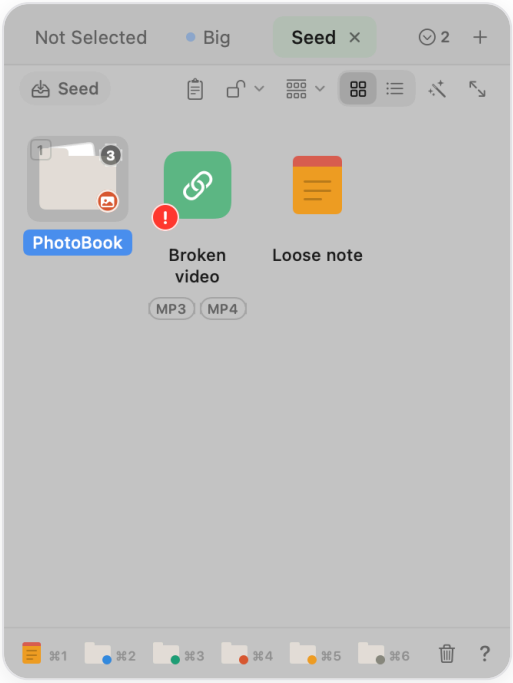


PhotoBook: pictures as thumbnails

FOLDER	HOLDS
Linker	Links — title and preview fetched automatically; a link dragged out becomes a small note with the clickable link.
PhotoBook	Pictures — with text inside them recognised, so search finds them.
Notepad	Notes — rich text (fonts, sizes, bold, colour, lists, emoji); saved as .txt or .rtf.
Files	Everything else — music, video, 3D, documents — copied into Stash by default.
Folder, Kraft, Pastel, Midnight	Your own folders, nested as deep as you like.

- **The wand** sorts loose things into Linker, PhotoBook, Notepad and Files. Deep Organize lives in Settings.
- **Names**: Return renames (or press-hold-release); new folders open their name box right away. Rename N Items gives a name and a number.
- **Colour tags**: Finder's seven colours, written onto the real files too.

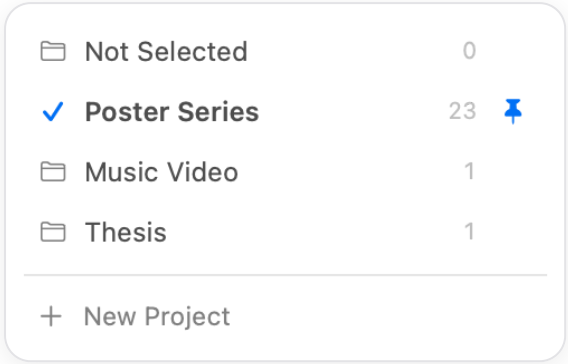
MP3 and MP4, built in



A download that didn't work keeps a red ! with the reason and Try Again

- **MP3 / MP4 chips** appear only on media links (YouTube and similar) and on video or sound files.
- One click downloads (links, via the built-in downloader) or converts (files, via the Mac's own media tools and the built-in MP3 encoder) — nothing to install.
- **Progress on the thing itself**: a see-through ring with the percent, and a small × to cancel.
- **The link moves inside the file**: when the MP3/MP4 is ready it takes the link's place, and the link lives on as a small badge on its corner — open it, copy it, put it back on the board, or remove it. No extra copies on the board.
- **If it fails**: a red ! stays on it — click for the reason, Try Again or Dismiss.

Tabs for what you're working on



The project list (▾ next to the tabs)

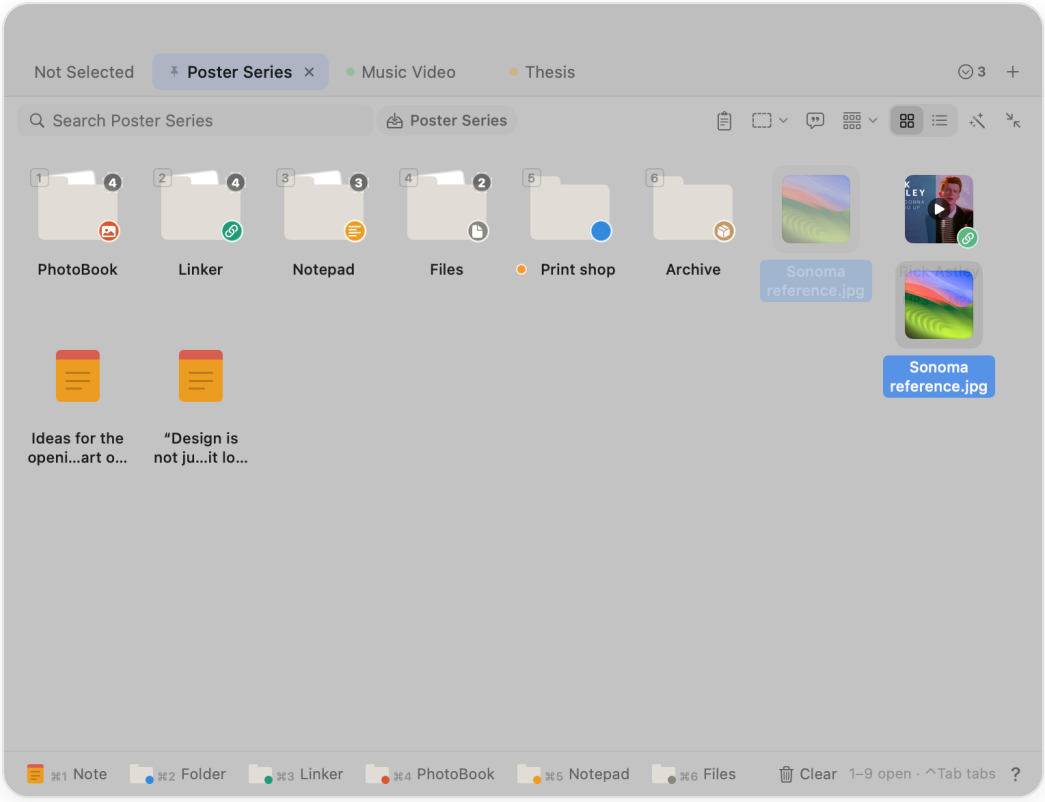
- **Tabs** show the pinned projects (📌) and the ones you opened last — as many as fit, always including the one you're in.
- The ▾ **list** shows every project with how much is in it and a pin; click to open, right-click to rename, pin, save to Mac or delete.
- **+** makes a new tab with its name box open.
- **Search** looks only in the tab you're in, and finds folders and things by name anywhere inside it.

Keys

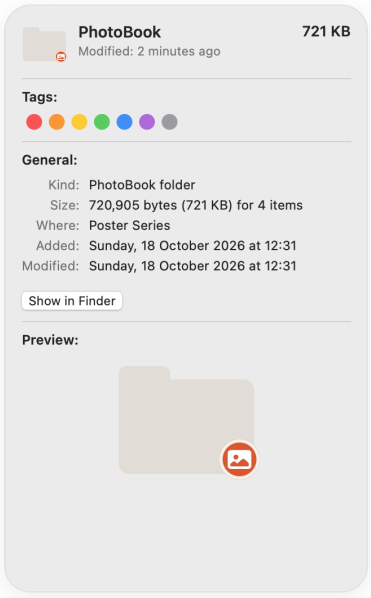
`⌥Space`	Open or close Stash from any app
`⌥⌘V`	Save the clipboard without opening Stash
`Return` · `⌘↓`	Rename · open
`Space`	Quick Look (notes open for editing)
`⌘⌫` · `⌘Z`	Delete · undo
`⌫` · `Tab`	Back up to the folder holding this one
`1–9` · `^Tab`	Open a numbered folder · next project tab
`⌘C` `⌘V` `⌘I` `⌘F` `⌘,`	Copy · paste · Get Info · search · Settings

07 · LIKE FINDER

Drag, Get Info, Quick Look



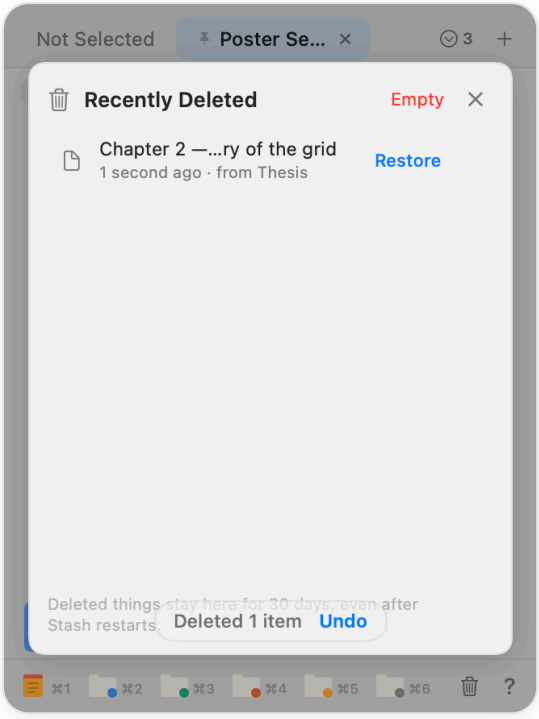
Dragging: the tile's picture follows the pointer; the real one waits, dimmed



Get Info (⌘I)

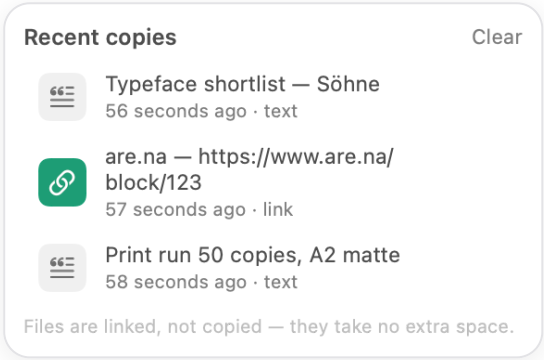
- **Dragging** starts instantly, selected or not; over a folder it goes inside; out of the window it becomes a real Mac file (a copy) in Finder, the Desktop or any app. Dragging a project tab out gives the whole project as a folder.
- **Get Info** shows kind, size, where it is, dates, the link, dimensions or duration, clickable colour tags, Show in Finder and a preview.
- **Quick Look** (Space) is the real macOS one: pictures, video, music, PDFs.
- **⌘C** copies what's selected; several notes and links paste one after another.

Undo, Recently Deleted, Recent copies



Recently Deleted, with the Undo message below

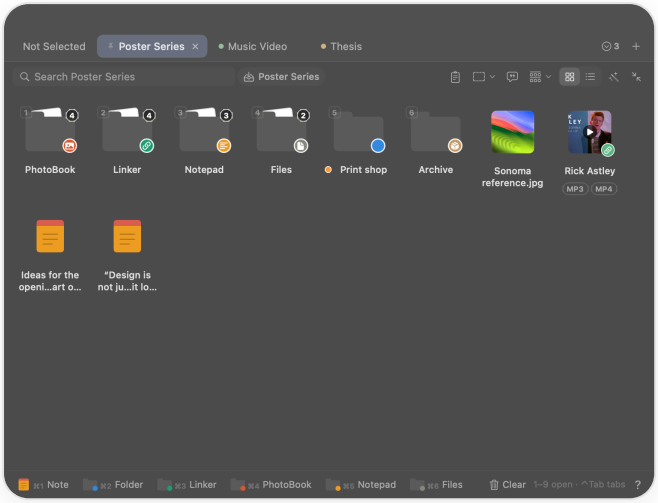
- **Undo in the message**: deleting, moving, renaming, clearing, organising and finished downloads show a message with **Undo**.
- **Recently Deleted**: everything deleted stays 30 days, even after a restart — Restore puts it back where it was.
- **Crash-safe saving**: saves are checked before they replace the old file; the previous version and compressed hourly backups are kept, and a damaged library is restored automatically.



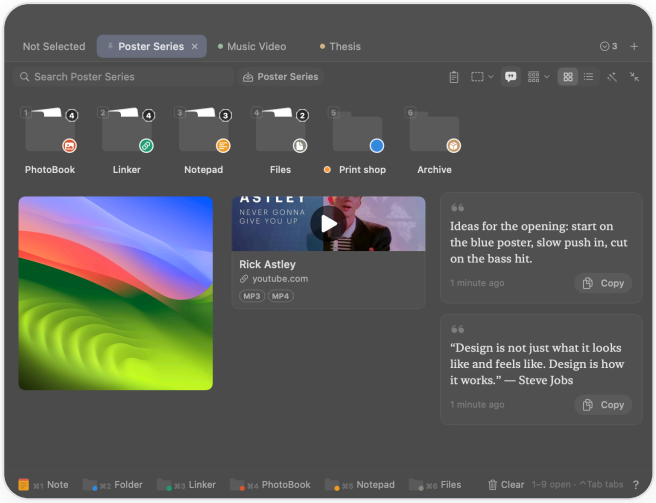
Recent copies (📋): the last 5 things you copied anywhere

- Click one to copy it again, save it to the board, or drag it out. Files are only linked, so they take no space; secrets from password managers are never kept.

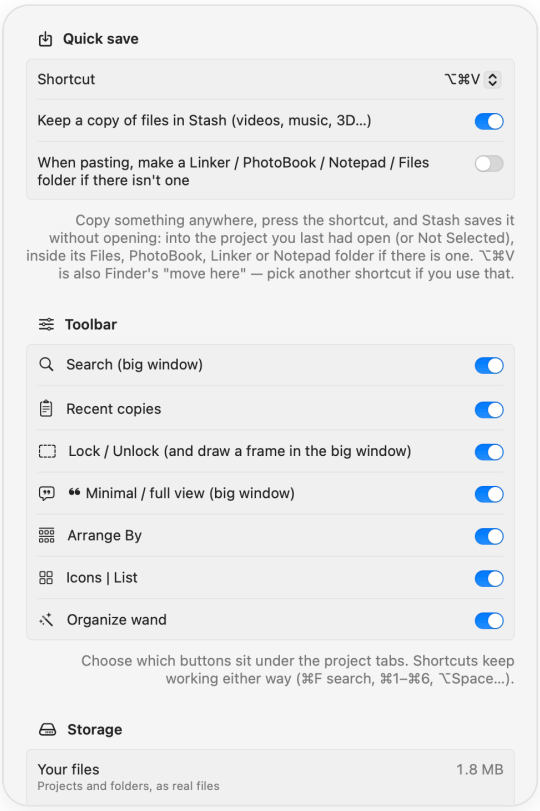
Day and what it keeps on disk



Night look (after 7 pm), minimal view



Night look, full view



Settings: quick save, toolbar, storage

- **Quick save**: choose the shortcut, keep copies of files, make typed folders when pasting.
- **Toolbar**: turn each header tool on or off.
- **Storage**: what Stash uses — your files, previews, Recently Deleted, library and backups, recent copies, temporary files, built-in tools — with safe clean-up buttons.
- **Save to Mac…** (right-click a tab): a live copy of a project in any folder you choose, kept up to date as you change things.
- **Accessibility**: VoiceOver names for every button, card and folder; Reduce Motion turns off animations.

Where your things live: `~/Documents/.Stash` — one folder per project, one per folder, the real files inside (notes as .txt/.rtf, links as .webloc, pictures and media as themselves).